09-04 第1篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Thin Grey Cat Who Chose Our Back Door

① The first time I saw the thin grey cat, it was a cold Tuesday evening at the start of October. I was taking the rubbish out when I noticed two round yellow eyes staring at me from under the stairs. The small animal did not move. Its grey fur was dirty, one ear had a small cut, and I could see its ribs through its chest. I slowly put down the rubbish bag, went back inside, and told Mum. She sighed. "Leave it some water. Don't make friends with a street cat. They bring fleas."

② For three evenings I set a small plastic bowl of water outside the back door. The water was gone each morning, but the cat was never there when I opened the door. Then, on the fourth evening, as I was locking the back gate, I felt something soft brush against my leg. I looked down. The grey cat was standing there, looking up at me, slightly shaking in the cold wind. "Hello," I said, in a very small voice. He did not answer, of course, but he did not run away either.

③ I went inside and looked at Mum. "Can we?" I asked, without finishing the sentence. Dad, who was reading the newspaper at the table, put it down slowly. "A cat is not a toy," he said. "It is a **responsibility** that comes in a furry coat." I nodded seriously. "I know. I will feed it, clean after it, and take it to the vet." Mum looked at Dad. Dad looked at Mum. "**One week**," Dad said at last. "If you keep your promises for one week, we will talk again."

④ That evening I carried a soft old towel to the corner of the back porch and put a paper box over it as a small shelter. I poured a little milk into a flat dish. The grey cat came out of the shadow very slowly, sniffed the milk twice, and then drank it, watching me with his big yellow eyes. When he finished, he licked the dish and walked silently back under the stairs. I did not even know what to call him yet.

⑤ The next morning, I got up early to wash the box with warm water and to put fresh newspaper inside. I named him **Little Ash**, because his fur was the colour of the cool ash at the bottom of a stove. At school that day, I wrote a small promise at the back of my notebook: "I will not forget Little Ash tonight." I kept the promise — that night, and the next, and the next. I cleaned his bowl every morning, changed his newspaper every other day, and saved a little fish from my own lunch box on Wednesdays. My mother, who had warned me about fleas, started leaving a small plate of rice on the porch too, pretending she did "nothing special".

⑥ On the ninth evening, I took Little Ash to a small neighbourhood vet after school, carrying him in a large paper box with a cloth lid. The vet, an old lady with kind eyes, smiled when she saw me. She checked his ear, gave him medicine for fleas, and quietly said, "This cat is about ten months old. He has been alone for a while, but he is not wild. He has chosen your door on purpose. Take care of him." When I walked out with the box, I felt something unusual in my chest — tall and warm, as if I had passed a test no one had officially set.

⑦ Three weeks later, Little Ash had a new collar, clean grey fur, and a favourite spot on the old chair by my desk. One Friday afternoon, while I was doing homework, he jumped up onto the corner of my table, curled into a soft circle beside my English book, and fell asleep. I wrote a slow sentence in my exercise book. Then I stopped. The world did not become suddenly perfect. The maths test on Monday did not become easier. But in that small corner of my desk, beside a sleeping grey cat, I understood something new: **to care for another life every single day** changes you in a way that no exam can measure.

⑧ Mum sometimes walks into my room now, stands quietly in the doorway, and says, "Come and see — the cat you 'didn't make friends with' is sleeping on your Maths book again." She is smiling when she says it. Dad has bought a small bag of cat food that he says is "only temporary, of course". And when I walk home in the cooling autumn wind, I know a small pair of yellow eyes will be waiting at the back gate, and I will smile in a way I never smiled before I met Little Ash.

注释： fleas 跳蚤；porch 门廊；vet 兽医；collar 颈圈；ribs 肋骨

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. How did the writer first become aware of the grey cat?

A. The cat walked into the living room while the writer was eating.
B. The writer saw two yellow eyes under the stairs while taking the rubbish out on a cold evening.
C. A classmate gave the cat to the writer.
D. The writer bought the cat at a pet shop.

2. What did Dad mean by saying, "A cat is not a toy — it is a responsibility that comes in a furry coat"?

A. Cats should be treated like small stuffed toys.
B. A cat is cute because of its furry coat.
C. Taking care of a cat means taking responsibility every day, not just playing when you feel like it.
D. Children should buy a new cat every month.

3. Why did the writer choose the name Little Ash?

A. Because the cat lived near a fire.
B. Because "Ash" was the cat's old name at another home.
C. Because the cat's fur was the colour of the cool ash at the bottom of a stove.
D. Because Dad suggested the name.

4. What did the old vet tell the writer about the grey cat?

A. The cat was over ten years old and completely wild.
B. The cat was very young, dangerous and should be sent back to the street.
C. The cat was about ten months old, not wild, and had chosen the writer's door on purpose.
D. The cat was too sick to keep.

5. Which sentence best expresses the main lesson of the story?

A. Stray cats must always be kept outside the house.
B. A pet is mainly a toy to make homework easier.
C. Caring for another life every single day changes us in ways no exam can measure.
D. Parents never really accept pets in the family.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第①段 "I was taking the rubbish out when I noticed two round yellow eyes staring at me from under the stairs"
【解析】首次相遇在倒垃圾时。A、C、D 均无依据。故选 B。

2.
【答案】C
【题型】句意理解题
【定位】第③段 "A cat is not a toy. It is a responsibility that comes in a furry coat"
【解析】爸爸强调养猫是长期责任而非玩具。A、B、D 均为字面误读。故选 C。

3.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】第⑤段 "I named him Little Ash, because his fur was the colour of the cool ash at the bottom of a stove"
【解析】因毛色似炉底灰而得名。A、B、D 均无依据。故选 C。

4.
【答案】C
【题型】细节理解题

【定位】第⑥段 "This cat is about ten months old. He has been alone for a while, but he is not wild. He has chosen your door on purpose"
【解析】兽医判定：年约十月，非野猫，主动选择了"我"家门口。A、B、D 均与原文不符。故选 C。

5.
【答案】C
【题型】主旨/写作意图题
【定位】第⑦段 "to care for another life every single day changes you in a way that no exam can measure"
【解析】每日照顾一条小生命所带来的改变是考试无法衡量的，为文章主题。A、B、D 均与原意相悖。故选 C。